

أَعُوذُ بِاللَّهِ مِنَ الشَّيْطَانِ الرَّجِيمِ

بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ

Lisan ul Quran — Lecture 7

The categories of Jam' · Jam' Salim and Jam' Mukassar

The verse with which the lesson opens

وَلَقَدْ ذَرَأْنَا لِجَهَنَّمَ كَثِيرًا مِّنَ الْجِنِّ وَالإِنسِ ۚ لَهُمْ قُلُوبٌ لَا يَفْقَهُونَ بِهَا ۚ وَهُمْ أَعْيُنٌ لَا يُبْصِرُونَ بِهَا ۚ وَهُمْ آذَانٌ لَا يَسْمَعُونَ بِهَا ۚ أُولَٰئِكَ كَالْأَنْعَامِ

بَلْ هُمْ أَضَلُّ ۚ أُولَٰئِكَ هُمُ الْغَافِلُونَ

(Surah al-A'raf: 179)

Translation: And We have created for Hell many of the jinn and mankind. They have hearts with which they do not understand, and eyes with which they do not see, and ears with which they do not hear. Such are like cattle — no, they are further astray. Such are the heedless.

In this verse Allah warns of Hell those jinn and human beings who make no use of the faculties He has given them. He gave them hearts, eyes and ears so that they might benefit from them, recognise their Master, observe His signs in the universe and in themselves, and listen to the truth attentively and accept it. When they failed to benefit from these, they proved to be like cattle, and indeed more astray than cattle. Cattle at least fulfil the demands of their nature and the purpose for which they were created, whereas these jinn and human beings are heedless of the purpose of their lives and unconcerned about the reckoning that follows death.

Its relevance to the lesson: This single verse contains four words in the *Jam' Mukassar*: قُلُوبٌ

، أَعْيُنٌ ، آذَانٌ ، أَنْعَامٌ . At the end of the lesson the pattern of each of the four is set out separately.

1. The 'Adad of the Ism

'*Adad* is the second aspect of the *Ism*. Arabic has three categories of number: the *Wahid* denotes one noun, the *Tathniyah* is the noun used for two, and the *Jam'* is for a number greater than two. This *Jam'* itself divides into two kinds: the *Jam' Salim* and the *Jam' Mukassar*.

2. Jam' Salim and Jam' Mukassar

Kind	Definition
Jam' Salim	A plural that is formed by a fixed rule. In it the singular noun remains present in its original form, sound and intact; only some letters are added at the end.
Jam' Mukassar	A plural for which there is no single fixed rule. In it the structure of the singular changes, that is, its letters or their order are altered. For this reason it is also called the broken plural, and Jam' Taksir. Such plurals must be memorised.

The two kinds of Jam' Salim

The *Jam' Salim* divides further into the *Jam' Mudhakkar Salim* and the *Jam' Mu'annath Salim*. Both are formed by a fixed method, and the *I'raab* of both changes with the position of the noun in the sentence.

Kind	How it is formed	Example
Jam' Mudhakkar Salim	Adding, in the state of raf', a silent waw preceded by a dammah with a noon carrying a fathah; and in nasb and jarr a silent yaa' preceded by a kasrah with a noon carrying a fathah	مُسْلِمٌ مُسْلِمُونَ / مُسْلِمِينَ
Jam' Mu'annath Salim	Adding an alif preceded by a fathah together with a taa', which carries a dammah in the state of raf' and a kasrah in nasb and jarr	مُسْلِمَةٌ مُسْلِمَاتُ / مُسْلِمَاتٍ

An essential rule: The *Jam' Mudhakkar Salim* is formed only from the '*alam* of a masculine *dhawi al-'uqul* (a rational being) and from its adjectives. So زَيْدٌ gives زَيْدُونَ and مُسْلِمٌ gives مُسْلِمُونَ, but قَلَمٌ does not give قَلَمُونَ and رَجُلٌ does not give رَجُلُونَ — the first is not *dhawi al-'uqul* and the second is not an adjective.

3. The Huroof Asliyyah and the system of patterns

Every Arabic noun rests on a few original letters, and on those same letters various forms, plurals and other words are built. These letters are called the *Huroof Asliyyah* or *Huroof ul Maddah*. Most nouns consist of three basic letters; some have four or five, but never more than five.

In Arabic *Sarf* and *Nahw*, three notional letters — ف، ع، ل — have been fixed. These three stand for the three basic letters of any noun. Placing a noun's original letters against them reveals its pattern: the first letter corresponds to the faa', the second to the 'ayn and the third to the laam.

The principle of the patterns

The *Jam' Mukassar* is not formed by a rule but memorised. Even so, Arabic has a set of well-known moulds for it, and the basic letters of a noun are poured into those moulds to form the plural. A full explanation of one pattern makes all the rest clear.

The make-up of the pattern أفعال: An additional hamzah comes at the beginning, then the first root letter is kept *sakin*, then a zabar is placed on the second root letter, then an additional alif is added, and finally the third root letter comes. So placing ع م ل into this mould gives أَعْمَال, and ص ح ب gives أَصْحَاب.

The word صَاحِب appears to have four letters, but its basic letters are only three: ص ح ب. The alif in the middle is additional. The same principle applies to every pattern.

4. The well-known patterns of the Jam' Mukassar

The table below gathers all the patterns taught in this lesson. With each pattern the singular and the plural are given so that the mould becomes fixed in the mind.

Pattern	Examples (singular ← plural)
أَفْعَال	عَمَل ← أَعْمَال ، صَوْت ← أَصْوَات ، صَاحِب ← أَصْحَاب ، نَعَم ← أَنْعَام
أَفْعُل	عَيْن ← أَعْيُن ، نَفْس ← أَنْفُس
فِعَال	بَعْر ← بَحَار ، رَجُل ← رِجَال ، جَبَل ← جِبَال ، عَبْد ← عِبَاد
فُعُول	قَلْب ← قُلُوب ، قَبْر ← قُبُور ، حَدّ ← حُدُود ، وَجْه ← وُجُوهُ
فُعُل	كِتَاب ← كُتُب ، رَسُول ← رُسُل ، سَرِير ← سُرُر ، صَحِيفَة ← صُحُف
فُعَال	كَافِر ← كُفَّار ، خَافِظ ← خُفَّاط ، خَادِم ← خُدَّام
فَعَالَة	فَاجِر ← فَجَرَة ، كَافِر ← كَفَرَة ، سَافِر ← سَفَرَة ، بَارّ ← بَرَرَة
أَفْعِلَة	فُؤَاد ← أَفْنَدَة ، سُؤَال ← أَسْئَلَة ، جَوَاب ← أَجْوِبَة ، لِسَان ← أَلْسِنَة
فُعَلَاء	شَهِيد ← شُهَدَاء ، شَرِيك ← شُرَكَاء ، سَفِيه ← سَفَهَاء ، شَاعِر ← شُعَرَاء
أَفْعِلَاء	نَبِيّ ← أَنْبِيَاء ، وَلِيّ ← أَوْلِيَاء ، عَمِيّ ← أَعْمِيَاء ، صَدِيق ← أَصْدِقَاء
فَوَاعِل	قَاعِدَة ← قَوَاعِد ، فَاكِهَة ← فَوَاكِه ، فَاحِشَة ← فَوَاحِش ، حَادِثَة ← حَوَادِث

Pattern	Examples (singular ← plural)
فَعَالِل	صَغِيرَةٌ ← صَغَائِرُ ، كَبِيرَةٌ ← كِبَائِرُ ، خَزَانَةٌ ← خَزَائِنُ ، خَبِيثَةٌ ← خَبَائِثُ
مَفَاعِل	مَشْرِقٌ ← مَشَارِقُ ، مَغْرِبٌ ← مَغَارِبُ ، مِفْتَاحٌ ← مَفَاتِحُ
مَفَاعِيل	مَسْكِينٌ ← مَسَاكِينُ ، مَصْبَاحٌ ← مَصَابِيحُ ، مِفْتَاحٌ ← مَفَاتِيحُ
فَعَلَى	مَيِّتٌ ← مَوْتَى ، مَرِيضٌ ← مَرَضَى ، صَرِيحٌ ← صَرَغَى ، قَتِيلٌ ← قَتْلَى

The make-up of some of the patterns

- **فَعَال** — a kasrah on the first letter, a fathah on the second, then an additional alif, and the third root letter at the end.
- **فُعُول** — a dammah on the first and second letters, then an additional waw, and the third root letter at the end.
- **فُعُل** — a dammah on the first and second letters, and the third root letter with no alif or waw at all.
- **فَعَلَةٌ** — a fathah on all three root letters, and a round ة at the end.
- **أَفْعَلَةٌ** — a hamzah with a fathah at the beginning, the second letter *sakin*, a kasrah on the third, a fathah on the fourth, and a round ة at the end.
- **فُعَلَاءَ** — a dammah on the first letter, a fathah on the second and third, and an alif with a hamzah at the end.
- **مَفَاعِل** and **مَفَاعِيل** — in these the meem and the alif are additional letters, over and above the *Huroof Asliyyah*, and are fixed in the pattern itself.
- **فَعَلَى** — this ends in an *Alif Maqsurah*, which is additional to the *Huroof Asliyyah*.

Worth noting: The plural of مِفْتَاح is مَفَاتِيح on the pattern مَفَاعِيل, yet in the Qur'an the word occurs in the form مَفَاتِح, that is, on the pattern مَفَاعِل لَا يَعْلَمُهَا إِلَّا هُوَ: مَفَاعِل (Surah al-An'am: 59).

Likewise words such as حَفَاط , خُدَام , أَجْوِيَّة , أَصْدِقَاء , and حَوَادِث do not occur in the Qur'an in these forms.

5. The categories of Jam' by the number of individuals

The *Jam'* is divided in another way as well, according to the number of individuals it denotes. On this basis there are two kinds: *Jam' Qillah* and *Jam' Kathrah*.

Kind	Definition	Patterns and examples
Jam' Qillah	A plural that denotes from three up to ten individuals	أَفْعَال (أَقْلَام) ، فِعْلَة (عِلْمَة) ، أَفْعُل (أَنْفُس) ، أَفْعَلَة (أَلْسِنَة) ، مُفْعِلُونَ (مُسْلِمُونَ) ، مُفْعِلَات (مُسْلِمَات)
Jam' Kathrah	A plural that denotes more than ten, that is, eleven and above	فِعَال (عِبَاد) ، فُعَلَاء (عِلْمَاء) ، أَفْعِلَاء (أَنْبِيَاء) ، فُعُل (رُسُل) ، فُعُول (جُؤم) ، فُعَال (خُدَام) ، فَعْلَى (مَرْضَى) ، فَعْلَة (طَلَبَة) ، فِعَل (فِرَق) ، فِعْلَان (عِلْمَان)

So the *Jam' Qillah* has six patterns, and a plural coming on any one of them is called a *Jam' Qillah*. The *Jam' Kathrah* has a great many patterns, of which a few of the best known are given above.

6. Jam' Muntaha al-Jumoo'

There is a kind of *Jam' Mukassar* from which no further *Jam' Mukassar* can be formed. The plural of سِوَار (a bangle) is أُسُورَة, and the plural of أُسُورَة is أُسَاوِر. Beyond this no further *Jam' Mukassar* can be made. Such a plural is called *Jam' Muntaha al-Jumoo'*, that is, the utmost limit of the plurals.

How the form is recognised: *Muntaha al-Jumoo'* is a form whose first letter carries a fathah and whose third position holds an alif, which is its mark. After that alif there is either a doubled letter, as in دَوَابُّ; or two letters of which the first carries a kasrah, as in مَسَاجِد; or three letters of which the first carries a kasrah and the second is *sakin*, as in مَفَاتِيح.

A few of the frequently used patterns of *Muntaha al-Jumoo'* are these:

- دَرَاهِم — as in دَرَاهِم
- دَنَائِر — as in دَنَائِر
- جَوَاهِر — as in جَوَاهِر
- مَسَاجِد — as in مَسَاجِد
- مَسَاكِين — as in مَسَاكِين

7. Ism ul Jam'

There is a basic difference between a *Jam'* and an *Ism ul Jam'*. A *Jam'* must have some singular, whether that singular is from its own word or from another word. An *Ism ul Jam'*, by contrast, is a word that carries the meaning of a plural but has no singular at all, as in قَوْمٌ and رَهْطٌ (a group) — both convey a body of people, yet neither has a singular.

Another case: Sometimes the singular and the plural are identical in shape and the difference is only one of consideration. The word فُلُكٌ means ships, and its singular is also فُلٌ, a ship. The distinction is drawn thus: when it is singular it stands on the pattern of فُلٌ (a lock), and when it is plural on the pattern of أُسْدٌ (many lions).

8. Evidence from the Qur'an and Hadith

وَلَنَا أَعْمَالُنَا وَلَكُمْ أَعْمَالُكُمْ

(Surah al-Baqarah: 139) Jam' Mukassar: أفعال — أَعْمَالٌ

Translation: For us are our deeds and for you are your deeds.

يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا لَا تَرْفَعُوا أَصْوَاتَكُمْ فَوْقَ صَوْتِ النَّبِيِّ

(Surah al-Hujurat: 2) Jam' Mukassar: أفعال — أَصْوَاتٌ

Translation: O you who believe, do not raise your voices above the voice of the Prophet.

أَلَمْ تَرَ كَيْفَ فَعَلَ رَبُّكَ بِأَصْحَابِ الْفِيلِ

(Surah al-Fil: 1) Jam' Mukassar: أفعال — أَصْحَابٌ

Translation: Have you not seen how your Lord dealt with the companions of the elephant?

وَعِبَادُ الرَّحْمَنِ الَّذِينَ يَمْشُونَ عَلَى الْأَرْضِ هَوْنًا وَإِذَا خَاطَبَهُمُ الْجَاهِلُونَ قَالُوا سَلَامًا

(Surah al-Furqan: 63) Jam' Mukassar: فِعَالٌ — عِبَادٌ

Translation: And the servants of the Most Merciful are those who walk upon the earth humbly, and when the ignorant address them, they say words of peace.

وَإِذَا الْقُبُورُ بُعْثِرَتْ

(Surah al-Infitar: 4) Jam' Mukassar: فُعُولٌ — قُبُورٌ

Translation: And when the graves are overturned.

تِلْكَ الرُّسُلُ فَضَّلْنَا بَعْضَهُمْ عَلَى بَعْضٍ

رُسُل — فُعِلَ Jam' Mukassar: (Surah al-Baqarah: 253)

Translation: These are the messengers; some of them We favoured above others.

أُولَئِكَ هُمُ الْكَافِرَةُ الْفَجَرَةُ

كَفَرَةٌ ، فَجَرَةٌ — فَعَلَتْ Jam' Mukassar: (Surah 'Abasa: 42)

Translation: Those are the disbelievers, the wicked.

يَوْمَ تَشْهَدُ عَلَيْهِمْ أَلْسِنَتُهُمْ وَأَيْدِيهِمْ وَأَرْجُلُهُمْ بِمَا كَانُوا يَعْمَلُونَ

أَلْسِنَةً — أَفْعَلَتْ Jam' Mukassar: (Surah an-Nur: 24)

Translation: On the day their tongues, their hands and their feet will bear witness against them for what they used to do.

وَإِذْ يَرْفَعُ إِبْرَاهِيمُ الْقَوَاعِدَ مِنَ الْبَيْتِ وَإِسْمَاعِيلُ

قَوَاعِدَ — فَوَاعِلَ Jam' Mukassar: (Surah al-Baqarah: 127)

Translation: And when Ibrahim and Isma'il were raising the foundations of the House.

وَلَقَدْ زَيَّنَّا السَّمَاءَ الدُّنْيَا بِمَصَابِيحَ

مَصَابِيحَ — مَفَاعِيلَ Jam' Mukassar: (Surah al-Mulk: 5)

Translation: And We have adorned the nearest heaven with lamps.

يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا كُتِبَ عَلَيْكُمُ الْقِصَاصُ فِي الْقَتْلِ

قَتْلَى — فَعَلَى Jam' Mukassar: (Surah al-Baqarah: 178)

Translation: O you who believe, retribution has been prescribed for you in the matter of the slain.

Hadith

الْمَاهِرُ بِالْقُرْآنِ مَعَ السَّفَرَةِ الْكِرَامِ الْبَرَّةِ، وَالَّذِي يَقْرَأُ الْقُرْآنَ وَيَتَتَعْتَعُ فِيهِ وَهُوَ عَلَيْهِ شَاقٌّ لَهُ أَجْرَانِ

(narrated from the Mother of the Believers, 'A'ishah, may Allah be pleased with her)

Translation: The one skilled in the Qur'an will be with the noble and righteous scribes; and the one who reads the Qur'an haltingly, finding it difficult, will have two rewards.

In this hadith both سَفَرَةٌ and بَرَّةٌ are *Jam' Mukassar* on the pattern فَعَلَةٌ.

The du'a for entering the lavatory

بِسْمِ اللَّهِ، اللَّهُمَّ إِنِّي أَعُوذُ بِكَ مِنَ الْخُبْثِ وَالْخَبَائِثِ

In this du'a حُبُّ stands on the pattern فُعْل and حَبَائِث on the pattern فَعَائِل — two patterns of the *Jam' Mukassar* present in a single everyday du'a.

9. Analysis of the opening verse

The verse read at the beginning of the lesson (Surah al-A'raf: 179) contains four words in the *Jam' Mukassar*:

Plural	Singular	Pattern	Meaning
قُلُوبٌ	قَلْبٌ	فُعُولٌ	hearts
أَعْيُنٌ	عَيْنٌ	أَفْعُلٌ	eyes
آذَانٌ	أُذُنٌ	أَفْعَالٌ	ears
أَنْعَامٌ	نَعَمٌ	أَفْعَالٌ	cattle

1. Define Jam' Salim and Jam' Mukassar, and bring out the basic difference between them.
2. Write the method of forming the Jam' Mudhakkar Salim and the Jam' Mu'annath Salim, with examples.
3. From which nouns is the Jam' Mudhakkar Salim formed? Write two words from which it cannot be formed.
4. What are the Huroof Asliyyah? Separate them out for مُنَافِق, صَاحِب, and مُصْنَبَح.
5. Describe the make-up of the pattern أَفْعَال and pour ع م ل into that mould to form the plural.
6. Write the Jam' Mukassar and the pattern for each of the following: مَرِيض, نَبِي, كَافِر, كِتَاب, رَجُل, قَلْب.
7. Write the singular of each of the following plurals: أَفْئِدَة, شُهَدَاء, خَزَائِن, مَشَارِق, قَتْلَى.

8. Define Jam' Qillah and Jam' Kathrah, and give three patterns of each with examples.
9. What is Jam' Muntaha al-Jumoo'? Explain using the example of سَوَارٍ.
10. Write five patterns of Muntaha al-Jumoo' with an example of each.
11. What is the difference between a Jam' and an Ism ul Jam'? Give two examples.
12. Take the four Jam' Mukassar words out of Surah al-A'raf verse 179 and write their singulars and patterns.

سُبْحَانَكَ اللَّهُمَّ وَبِحَمْدِكَ، أَشْهَدُ أَنْ لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا أَنْتَ، أَسْتَغْفِرُكَ وَأَتُوبُ إِلَيْكَ

اللَّهُمَّ صَلِّ عَلَى مُحَمَّدٍ وَعَلَى آلِ مُحَمَّدٍ كَمَا صَلَّيْتَ عَلَى إِبْرَاهِيمَ وَعَلَى آلِ إِبْرَاهِيمَ إِنَّكَ حَمِيدٌ مَجِيدٌ

اللَّهُمَّ بَارِكْ عَلَى مُحَمَّدٍ وَعَلَى آلِ مُحَمَّدٍ كَمَا بَارَكْتَ عَلَى إِبْرَاهِيمَ وَعَلَى آلِ إِبْرَاهِيمَ إِنَّكَ حَمِيدٌ مَجِيدٌ